Resume and Reflection Paper

Zhillan Qisa Zhahiran – 21040124190193 - IUP

Resume

This paper examines how technological infrastructure and financial resources drive digital-innovation adoption in Indonesia's public sector, and how that adoption feeds into public service quality and government performance. The authors surveyed 440 respondents in Banten Province: government officials, policymakers, and professionals across several sectors, ages spread fairly evenly from 25 to 54. Their central claim: digital transformation in government requires foundational support first. Without reliable networks, functioning hardware and software, and adequate budgets, digital-innovation efforts stall no matter what the policy says.

Infrastructure and financial resources each have a significant effect on digital-innovation adoption, confirming both as real preconditions for e-government progress. Adoption connects to stronger public service quality and government performance, but the path isn't straight. Adoption's mediating role shifts with context. The authors challenge the assumption that infrastructure and funding convert automatically into results. Infrastructure matters directly, and it matters through these tangled, locally dependent pathways.

For policymakers, infrastructure and funding mark a starting point, not a finish line. Governments need to track how digital tools get used in practice. The authors call for more cross-contextual, qualitative, and longitudinal research to work out these dynamics.

Reflection

Set against what's happened in Bandung, this study rang true to me. Over the past decade the city has poured resources into its technological infrastructure. The Bandung Command Center, integrated e-government platforms, and open-data initiatives are well-documented examples of digital-innovation adoption at the local level. This matches the study's central claim that infrastructure and funding function as enablers of digital transformation, not an afterthought. Bandung is a provncial capital and a major metro center, and that fiscal capacity lets it sustain these investments in ways smaller, less resourced municipalities can't. That says a lot about how much the financial-resource side of the study's model matters in practice.

The paper's warning against assuming a straight line from adopting digital tools to better government performance matches what I see in Bandung. Deploying a dashboard or an app citywide doesn't mean every kelurahan's residents get better service. Closing that gap depends on staff, who need training, incentives, and workflows built around the technology. It also depends on citizens, who need the digital literacy, trust, and access to use it. Bandung's digital divide sits between a well connected urban core and lower-income, peripheral neighborhoods. It shows the tangled, context-specific relationship the authors say needs more research.

This study is cross-sectional and survey-based, so it captures perceptions at a single point in time. Its respondents are in Banten Province, which has its own governance culture, fiscal capacity, and digital maturity, different from West Java's. Bandung is a large, digitally mature metro with a longer history of smart city investment, and it may sit further along the infrastructure-and-adoption curve than the average locality in that sample. The findings hold as a general framework, but any specific claims about Bandung's digital transformation need locally grounded research, not a direct transplant of these results.

For governance and accountability work in Bandung, this study's real lesson concerns how success gets measured. Counting systems built or budget spent isn't enough. Service quality and institutional performance have to improve downstream for the effort to count. That means paying attention to the human and organizational factors that decide whether the technology works across the city's very different neighborhoods.

Source: *Purnamasari, R., Hasanudin, A. I., Zulfikar, R., & Yazid, H. (2025). Technological infrastructure and financial resource availability in enhancing public services and government performance: The role of digital innovation adoption in Indonesia. Social Sciences & Humanities Open, 11, 101621. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssaho.2025.101621*